

AI Won't Wipe My Mother's Ass

Why care must be at the core of
the age of artificial intelligence



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*Why care must be at the core of the age
of artificial intelligence*

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PROLOGUE



I wish I had been more available. I wish I had enjoyed more of my children growing up, and taken better care of some of my friends. There was simply no time.

So now I am writing a book — as a father, as an artist and as a human being — about care. Not only healthcare, and not only AI. Simple care. In my life, my sister got cancer and I wanted to help her. My mother got dementia so suddenly my father was alone and I wanted to help them. My children had their problems, and my availability was scarce.

I wasn't always there, because of my career, my ambitions, my plans. Many people I have spoken to tell me the same story. I wish I had been more available, had enjoyed more of my children's growth, had cared more for family and friends. There was simply no time.

In the shift to AI there will be more time. That time should be invested in care. Not only in wiping my mother's ass, but in the comfort of knowing that it is normal to spend time on the needs of other people, on children, and even on something bigger: nature.

Care means something simple. Being there when you are needed. Being a real human, connected to your deepest mind and feelings — the ones that were always there, long before the internet and AI. This book is a challenge to think about what we

can do with our time.

Who do we care enough about to give them our time?

Our partner, our children, our parents, family, friends, the animals who need us. And the question underneath: do they need your presence and your care? Of course they do. That is a basic human necessity. Some moments make it visible — usually the moments when life hurts.

What do we care enough about to give it our time?

Nature, the places where we live, people who are not born yet, governments, music, art and ideas all need our care, one way or another.

That is care.

Artificial intelligence enters this story because we are giving machines extraordinary power before we have properly answered a much simpler question:

What do we want that AI power for?

That is this book. AI won't wipe my mother's ass: one day, the asses of Bill Gates, Elon Musk, Jeff Bezos, Mark Zuckerberg and Sundar Pichai will need to be wiped too. Will they be proud, in that moment, of what is being developed now with their support? I hope so. Because that would mean care has found its place inside AI and the large language models.

At the end of this book I write down design rules for AI with care at the core — and the questions that still need to be answered, or at least thought about.

PART ONE

WHAT MATTERS?



*Before we discuss AI, money or politics, we should establish
the thing they are supposed to serve.*

Human life.

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I WORKED TOO MUCH



I worked fifty or sixty hours a week. That seemed normal for my generation. It was normal for me, and it is still in my blood. There was always something “important” to do. But your heart breaks when you realize that your availability was greater for the people you worked with than for your own family. And when I see my children dealing with everything on TikTok and Snapchat, I can’t even imagine what that is like. Their world moves so much faster than mine ever did. The pressure they live with is harder for me, at fifty-six, to imagine.

Nobody decides: I will miss part of my children’s childhood.

Everybody decides: I have to earn an income so my family can have a decent life.

I wanted to pay taxes, so society would have a standard in which my kids could thrive and grow. I wanted to be an artist — to be creative, to develop, to explore. And, last but not least, I am an idealist with a social conscience, so I wanted to do voluntary work too. And then, finally, I would take my canoe out and paddle in silence, a tiny part of a much bigger world. Out there I realized something: media is only a tiny piece of what we really need as human beings.

This does not mean I know how my children's lives would have turned out if I had worked less. Nobody knows that. But we are now designing a new world with AI. That is a large opportunity to change some of the rules that shaped me, and to build a future full of care.

I do know what I missed because of too much work. Time to talk, to argue, to cook, to go outside, to laugh. Time to be bored together, to invent things, to think about care for parents and grandparents, family, friends. That is just a shortlist. The list gets longer the more you think about it.

I cannot buy those years back. But I can write about them, because I have watched the internet develop and AI arrive. I can question the past and hope to nudge the future.

That is where this book's first serious question comes from:

Why did we build a society in which being a good worker can make it harder to have enough time to be a father?



*Care must be at the core —
of our lives, and of what we build.*

END OF PREVIEW

The complete book — 22 chapters and the design rules for AI with care at the core — is available as an e-book from 1 October 2026.

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